MIL-R-37009
21 September 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

RETRACTOR, VAGINAL, PLASTIC, DISPOSABLE, 50s.

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, self-retaining, disposable vaginal retractor, suitable for use in obstetrical procedures and specifically for episiotomy repair.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

L-P-390	Plastic, Molding and Extrusion Material, Polyethylene and Copolymers (Low, Medium, and High Density).
PPP-B-585	Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Box, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof.
MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Strip Test, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 6515

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply:

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The Pharmacopeia of The United States of America (U.S.P.)

(Application for copies shall be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pennsylvania 18042).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The vaginal retractor shall be fabricated from polyethylene in accordance with Federal Specification L-P-390C Type 1, Class H, Grade 5.

3.1.1 Color. The color of the vaginal retractor shall be white.

3.2 Style, design and dimensions. Retractors shall be sterile, disposable, and constructed of two halves, connected by an integral hinge. Shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

3.3 Identification marking. Each vaginal retractor shall clearly and legibly bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark.

3.4 Sterility. The retractors shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.)
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.

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j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.4.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The retractors shall show a smooth finished outer surface free from pits, flash, scale and holes. All edges shall be smooth.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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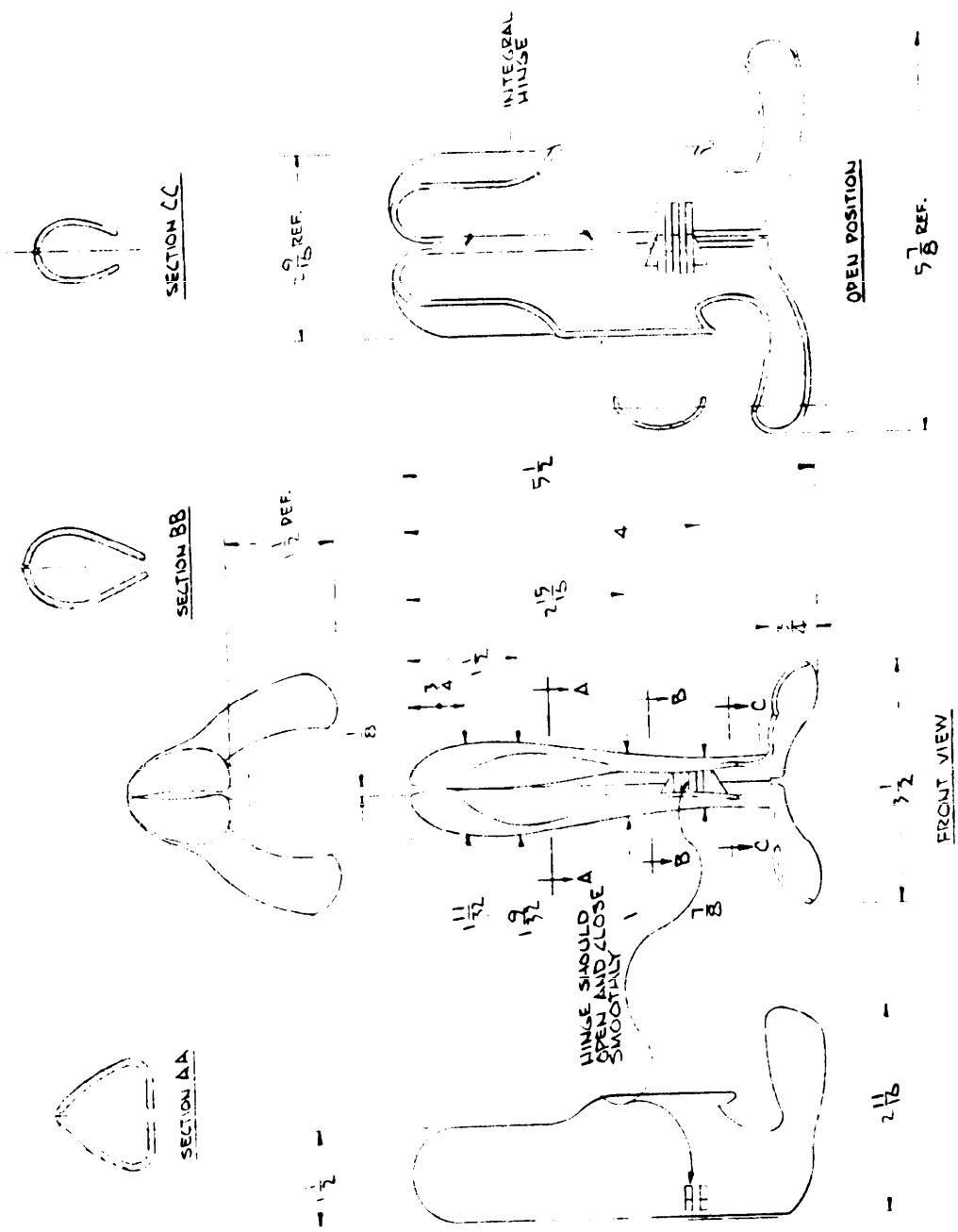


FIGURE 1

RETRACTOR, VAGINAL, PLASTIC, DISPOSABLE

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4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the polyethylene, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one vaginal retractor.

Table I. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	None defined.	None defined.

4.2.2 For tests.

4.2.2.1 For sterility test. Sampling for sterility shall be in accordance with the U.S.P. for parenteral devices and as specified in 4.4.1.

4.2.2.2 For other tests. Sampling for other tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II. The unit of product for testing purposes shall be one vaginal retractor. Where feasible the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Defective retractors shall be rejected.

Table II. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Insp. level	AQL
Retractor	Dimensions	3.2	—	S-1	1.0
	Sterility test	3.4	4.4.1.	—	*

* No defects permitted.

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4.3 Examination. The retractors shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any units in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective units in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Catagories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Edges not smoothly finished.
102	Surfaces not smooth.
103	Two halves of retractor do not open and close smoothly.
Minor	None defined.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Sterility test. The vaginal retractors shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for Parenteral devices using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.4.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in Table II, Sampling Criteria for Tests.

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4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var.niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.1. Sterility test and 4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.1.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.4.1.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.1.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the U.S.P.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing fifty retractors, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

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5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior Container
1 unit	Not required	2 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Individual container. Each retractor shall be packaged in a sealed, tamperproof, peel open type container of appropriate size and design. The container shall be designed with tabs to facilitate opening. In addition, the container shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened.

5.1.3.2 Unit package. Fifty individual packages shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Method I closure as specified in PPP-B-636 shall be utilized.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements specified in PPP-B-636.

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5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix therto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.3 Closure. Closure of wood boxes shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification. Closure of each fiberboard box shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.4 Strapping. Strapping, when required, shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of wood boxes shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II as specified in PPP-B-636. In addition, fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial container of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual container. In addition to any commercial markings, each individual package shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. Marking shall also include the lot (control) number, item identification, manufacturer's name and address, and the legend: "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED" or similar statement.

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5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-9/73-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The vaginal retractors are intended for repair of episiotomy.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

NATIONAL STOCK NO.	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-149-0118	RETRACTOR, VAGINAL, Disposable, 50s.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1770

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT-PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS. The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-R-37009

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4 REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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